

Absolutely — **niche** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...which has helped them **carve out a niche** in the local area.”

Here **niche** means **a small, specialized position or segment in a market where a business can serve a particular group or need**. But **niche** also has important meanings in **architecture, ecology, careers/roles, audiences, and specialized interests**.

Word family: **niche / niche-market / niched**

Base word: niche

Plural: niches

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-like modifier (名詞作前置修飾) / rare verb uses

Pronunciation note:

> **niche** can be pronounced /ni:f/ or /nɪtʃ/

Both are standard, though /ni:f/ is very common internationally.

Meaning in your passage: **niche = specialized market position — 利基；細分市場；專門定位**

Your sentence:

> “...helped them **carve out a niche** in the local area.”

Here **niche** means:

> **a small, specialized part of a market where a business serves a particular customer need or distinguishes itself from competitors.**

繁體中文：

市場中較小而專門、針對特定需求或客群的位置；利基市場 / 特色定位

Natural translation:

> “...helped them carve out a niche in the local area.”

「.....幫助他們在本地市場中**建立自己的利基 / 特色定位**。」

So here:

> **niche = 專門而有差異化的市場位置**

1. **niche = specialized market segment — 利基市場；細分市場**

The exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The bakery has carved out a **niche** in the local area.”

「這間麵包店在本地建立了自己的**利基市場 / 特色定位**。」

Practice 2

> “The company found a profitable **niche** selling handmade products.”

「這家公司靠售賣手工產品找到了一個有利可圖的**利基市場**。」

Practice 3

> “Small firms often succeed by serving a specific niche.”

「小型企業往往靠服務特定**細分市場**而成功。」

niche — business = 規模較小但需求明確、競爭較集中的特定市場區塊

2. **niche = specialized role or position — 專門位置；合適角色**

A major figurative/general meaning.

Practice 4

> “She found her **niche** in graphic design.”

「她在平面設計領域找到了最適合自己的**定位 / 專長位置**。」

Practice 5

> “He has created a niche for himself as a food photographer.”

「他把自己定位成美食攝影師，建立了自己的**專門角色**。」

niche = 某人最適合、最有優勢或最能發揮的專門角色 / 位置

3. **find one's niche = 找到最適合自己的定位**

A very common expression.

Practice 6

> “It took her years to **find her niche**.”

「她花了幾年才**找到最適合自己的定位**。」

Practice 7

> “The bakery found its niche by focusing on custom cakes.”

「這間麵包店靠專注訂製蛋糕，找到自己的**市場定位**。」

find one's niche = 找到最適合自己的專長、角色或市場位置

4. **niche = small specialized audience/interest group — 小眾領域；特定受眾**

A common media/culture use.

Practice 8

> “The magazine appeals to a **niche audience**.”

「這本雜誌主要吸引**小眾受眾**。」

Practice 9

> “It began as a niche interest but later became mainstream.”

「它最初只是**小眾興趣**，後來才變成主流。」

niche = 規模較小、興趣或需求高度集中的特定群體 / 領域

5. **niche market = 利基市場**

A major business compound.

Practice 10

> “The brand targets a **niche market**.”

「這個品牌鎖定一個**利基市場**。」

Practice 11

> “Niche markets can be attractive to small businesses.”

「**利基市場**對小型企業可能很有吸引力。」

niche market = 規模較小、顧客需求明確而專門的市場

6. **niche product** = 小眾產品；利基產品

Practice 12

> “This is a **niche product** for serious bakers.”

「這是一款針對專業烘焙愛好者的**小眾產品**。」

Practice 13

> “The company sells niche products with limited but loyal demand.”

「公司出售需求規模不大但顧客忠誠度高的**利基產品**。」

niche product = 為特定小群客戶而設計的專門產品

7. **niche audience** = 小眾受眾；特定觀眾群

Practice 14

> “The documentary attracted a **niche audience**.”

「這部紀錄片吸引了一群**小眾觀眾**。」

Practice 15

> “The channel serves a niche audience interested in baking.”

「這個頻道服務對烘焙有興趣的****特定小眾受眾****。」

****niche audience = 興趣高度集中但規模較小的觀眾 / 讀者群****

8. ****niche = recess in a wall — 壁龕；牆壁凹位****

A completely distinct architectural meaning.

Practice 16

> “The statue stood in a ****niche**** in the wall.”

「雕像放在牆上的一個****壁龕 / 凹位****中。」

Practice 17

> “A lamp was placed in a small niche beside the door.”

「門旁的小****凹位****裡放了一盞燈。」

****niche — architecture = 牆面向內凹入的小空間，常用來放雕像、裝飾品等****

This is one of the strongest MCQ contrasts with the business sense.

9. ****niche = ecological role of a species — 生態位****

A major scientific meaning.

Practice 18

> “Each species occupies a particular ecological ****niche****.”

「每個物種都佔據特定的****生態位****。」

Practice 19

> “The two animals compete for the same niche.”

「這兩種動物競爭同一個****生態位****。」

****niche — ecology = 一個物種在生態系統中的角色、資源使用方式和生存位置****

This is broader than simply:

> habitat

10. **ecological niche = 生態位**

Practice 20

> “Diet is one part of an animal’s **ecological niche**.”

「飲食是動物**生態位**的一部分。」

Practice 21

> “Changes in climate can alter ecological niches.”

「氣候變化可能改變物種的**生態位**。」

ecological niche = 物種如何利用環境、食物、空間及與其他生物互動的整體角色

11. **niche = suitable place for something — 適合的位置；專屬位置**

A broader abstract extension.

Practice 22

> “The product fills a useful **niche**.”

「這款產品填補了一個有用的**市場空缺 / 專門位置**。」

Practice 23

> “The service occupies a unique niche between luxury and mass-market products.”

「這項服務在奢華與大眾產品之間佔據一個獨特的**定位**。」

niche = 某人 / 某物特別適合佔據的一個位置或功能區域

12. **fill a niche = 填補特定空缺 / 需求**

A common figurative expression.

Practice 24

> “The bakery ****fills a niche**** for handmade celebration cakes.”

「這間麵包店填補了手工慶祝蛋糕這個****特定市場需求****。」

Practice 25

> “The app fills a niche that larger services ignore.”

「這個應用程式填補了大型服務忽略的一個****市場空缺****。」

****fill a niche = 滿足一個原本未被充分服務的特定需求****

Important distinction: ****niche vs market****

****market****

broad:

all potential buyers/sellers for a product or service.

****niche****

narrower:

a specialized subsection of that market.

> bakery market

> = 烘焙市場

> custom-cake niche

> = 訂製蛋糕利基市場

So:

> niche $\subset$ market

Important distinction: ****niche vs segment****

****segment****

= any subdivided part of a market.

niche

= usually smaller and more specialized, often with specific unmet needs.

> market segment

> = 市場區隔

> niche market

> = 利基市場

A niche is usually a narrower segment.

Important distinction: **niche vs specialty**

specialty

= what someone/company is especially good at.

niche

= the specialized position/market served.

> custom cakes are the bakery's specialty

> = 訂製蛋糕是店家的專長

> custom cakes helped create its niche

> = 訂製蛋糕幫助它建立利基定位

Different focus.

Important distinction: **niche vs unique selling point**

niche

= the market position/customer segment.

unique selling point

= specific feature that differentiates the product/business.

For example:

- > niche = local custom celebration cakes
- > USP = handmade designs delivered within 24 hours

Related but not identical.

Important distinction: **niche vs brand identity**

niche

= where the business sits in the market.

brand identity

= how the brand presents and defines itself.

A niche can influence brand identity, but they are different concepts.

Important distinction: **niche vs role**

role

= function/job someone performs.

niche

= specialized position where someone fits especially well.

> role in a team

> = 團隊角色

> niche in a profession

> = 職業中的專門定位

Niche often implies a particularly good fit.

Important distinction: **niche vs habitat**

This is crucial in ecology.

habitat

= physical place where an organism lives.

niche

= how it lives there:

- * what it eats
- * what eats it
- * when it is active
- * what resources it uses
- * what ecological role it performs

So:

- > habitat = 生境
- > niche = 生態位

Classic exam contrast.

Important distinction: **niche — business vs architecture**

Business:

> “The bakery has found a niche.”

= 麵包店找到自己的市場定位。

Architecture:

> “The statue stands in a niche.”

= 雕像放在壁龕裡。

Completely different modern meanings.

Important distinction: **niche — market vs ecology**

Business:

> specialized market position

Ecology:

> species' specialized role in ecosystem

Interestingly, both share the deeper concept:

> **a specialized place/role where something fits**

So conceptually related, but domain meanings should remain distinct for MCQ purposes.

Important distinction: **niche audience vs small audience**

small audience

= simply not many people.

niche audience

= small because the content targets a specialized interest.

So:

> small ≠ necessarily niche

A niche audience has **specific shared interests**.

Important distinction: **niche product vs unpopular product**

niche product

= intentionally designed for a small specialized market.

unpopular product

= simply not liked/bought much.

A niche product may be very successful within its target group.

Important distinction: ****niche vs mainstream****

****niche****

= specialized/small target group.

****mainstream****

= broad/general audience or market.

> niche bakery product

> = 小眾專門產品

> mainstream bakery product

> = 大眾化產品

Direct contrast.

Important distinction: ****find a niche vs carve out a niche****

You just curated ****carve****.

****find a niche****

= discover a suitable specialized position.

****carve out a niche****

= actively build/create that position through effort.

So your passage chooses the stronger expression:

> ****carve out a niche****

because the bakery developed differentiation through custom cakes.

Important distinction: ****fill a niche vs carve out a niche****

****fill a niche****

= satisfy an unmet need.

****carve out a niche****

= establish your own distinct position.

A business can do both:

1. fill an unmet need;
2. thereby carve out a niche.

Important pronunciation note

Two common pronunciations:

> /ni:f/

> /nɪtʃ/

Both are standard.

For learners, ****/ni:f/**** is a safe, widely understood default.

Important note on polysemy depth

****Niche**** has a compact but strong set of genuinely distinct modern meanings:

1. ****specialized market/role****
2. ****architectural recess****
3. ****ecological role****
4. broader ****specialized position/fit****

Then useful compounds:

- * niche market
- * niche product
- * niche audience
- * ecological niche

We should not over-split every “specialized role” context into a new lexical sense.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **niche — market** = 利基 / 細分市場
* **niche — specialized role** = 專門定位 / 合適角色
* **find one's niche** = 找到自己的定位
* **niche audience** = 小眾受眾
* **niche market** = 利基市場
* **niche product** = 小眾 / 利基產品
* **niche — architecture** = 壁龕 / 牆壁凹位
* **niche — ecology** = 生態位
* **ecological niche** = 生態位
* **fill a niche** = 填補特定市場 / 功能空缺
* **carve out a niche** = 開拓利基 / 建立獨特定位

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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niche — business	市場中規模較小、需求明確、針對特定客群或需求的專門位置
niche — role	某人 / 某物特別適合並能發揮優勢的專門角色或位置
find one's niche	找到最適合自己的專長、角色或市場定位
niche audience	因共同特殊興趣而形成的較小受眾群
niche product	專門為較小、特定客群設計的產品
niche — architecture	牆面向內凹入、常用來放置雕像或裝飾物的小空間
niche — ecology	一個物種在生態系統中的角色、資源使用方式和生存位置
fill a niche	滿足原本未被充分服務的特定需求 / 空缺
carve out a niche	靠差異化和努力逐步建立獨特的市場 / 專業定位

For your original sentence

> “...they also make custom birthday cakes, which has helped them **carve out a niche** in the local area.”

The exact meaning is:

niche = Golden Crust 靠訂製生日蛋糕這種較具特色的服務，在本地烘焙市場中建立出一個較小但明確、有特定顧客需求的專門位置。

Natural translation:

> **「他們也會製作訂製生日蛋糕，而這幫助他們在區內建立了自己的利基市場 / 特色定位。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****niche market**** → 利基市場
- > ****niche audience**** → 小眾受眾
- > ****find your niche**** → 找到最適合自己的定位
- > ****carve out a niche**** → 開拓 / 建立獨特定位
- > ****fill a niche**** → 填補特定市場空缺
- > ****architectural niche**** → 壁龕
- > ****ecological niche**** → 生態位
- > ****niche vs market**** → 專門細分位置 vs 整體市場